ERIC MARCON

Currently lecturer and researcher with AgroParisTech, PhD.

I am a researcher in Tropical Ecology with Amap lab, a professor at AgroParisTech and a coordinator of the BioGET course of the Biodiversity, Ecology and Evolution master's degree at AgroParisTech and Montpellier University.

I'm the director of training with Ceba Excellence Laboratory (Centre d'Etudes de la Biodiversité Amazonienne),a member of the Scientific Council of the French Office for Biodiversity and a member of the domain committee *Sustainable management of Natural Resources - Biodiversity* of the French Ministry of Ecology.

I am 58 years old and I live in Montpellier, France.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Présent | 2020
Lecturer-researcher in charge of a master's programme
AgroParisTech, Amap lab. — Montpellier, France

2020 | 2006
Campus director with AgroParisTech
AgroParisTech — Kourou, French Guiana

2006 | 2002
Educational engineer
Ecole Nationale du Génie Rural, des Eaux et des Forêts (post-graduate, environment engineering and public administration school, now merged with AgroParisTech)
Kourou, French Guiana

2002 | 1999
Head of IT at Cemagref General Management
Research Institute for Agricultural and Environmental Engineering (now merged with Inrae: National Research Institute for Agriculture, Food and Environment)
Antony, France

1997 | 1995
Head of IT at Engref General Management
Ecole Nationale du Génie Rural, des Eaux et des Forêts
Paris, France

1995 | 1991
Forest engineer
Head of Division with the National Forest Office
Charleville-Mézières, France

EDUCATION

2016
University of French Guiana
Habilitation à Diriger des Recherches (French qualification to supervise research) in Ecology
Kourou, French Guiana

Thesis: Measuring biodiversity and spatial structures (in French)

CONTACT INFO

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Home Page
Github
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SKILLS

Experienced in management, research, teaching, forestry and IT.

Skilled in ecology, economics, forest science, statistics, data analysis and modelling.

Highly skilled in R.

LANGUAGE

French: mother tongue (C2)
English: fluent (C1)
Italian: advanced (B2)
Portuguese: advanced (B1)
Spanish: operational (A2)

Last updated on March 02 2026.

2010

AgroParisTech
PhD in Ecology — Paris, France

Thesis: Spatial statistics with applications to ecology and economics (in French)

1999

Ecole Nationale du Génie Rural, des Eaux et des Forêts
Post-Graduate Engineering School of Public Administration
Paris, France

1999

University of Paris, Panthéon Sorbonne
MSc in International Economic — Paris, france

Thesis: The international timber trade (in French)

1990

Ecole Nationale des Ingénieurs des Travaux des Eaux et Forêts
Graduate Engineering School of Forestry
Nogent sur Vernisson, France

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Present | 2020

Researcher in Tropical Ecology
Associate researcher at AMAP lab. — Montpellier, France
Amap Lab

2020 | 2006

Head of Research Unit Ecology of Guiana Forests
AgroParisTech — Kourou, French Guiana
EcoFoG Lab
• Deputy director from 2006 to 2009 and director from 2010.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Present | 2020

Biodiversity, Ecology and Evolution, BioGET master's programme
AgroParisTech and University of Montpellier — Montpellier, France
Master BioGET
I coordinate the Plant Biodiversity and Management of Tropical Ecosystems (BioGET) programme, which is co-organised by the University of Montpellier and AgroParisTech.

Present | 2022

AgroParisTech final year
AgroParisTech — Montpellier, France
Geeft MSc
I teach tropical forest ecology, epistemology in ecology and statistics with R to final-year, graduate engineering students in the Environmental Management of Tropical Ecosystems and Forests major.

Present | 2010

Biodiversity, Ecology and Evolution, EFT master's programme
AgroParisTech and University of French Guiana
Kourou, French Guiana
EFT MSc
Tropimundo MSc
I teach biodiversity measurement and species abundance distributions to Master 2 students in the Ecology of Tropical Forests programme. This course receives students from the Erasmus Mundus Tropimundo Master's, coordinated by the Free University of Brussels.

Present | 2022

Erasmus Mundus Global Forestry master's programme
University of Copenhagen — Copenhagen, Denmark

I teach tropical forest ecology and sustainable forest management in the Erasmus Mundus Global Forestry Master 1 programme, coordinated by the University of Copenhagen.

Global Forestry MSc

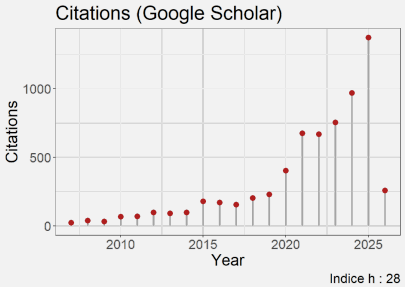
PUBLICATIONS

Present | 2012

Measurement of Biodiversity

I wrote a series of papers to contribute to the development of methods to measure diversity rigorously, including an R package and a book.

- Marcon, E., Mirabel, A., Molino, J.-F., Sabatier, D. (2024). Estimation of the number of tree species in French Guiana by extrapolation of permanent plots richness. *Journal of Tropical Ecology*, 40, e11.
- Grabchak, M., Marcon, E., Lang, G., & Zhang, Z. (2017). The generalized Simpson's entropy is a measure of biodiversity. *Plos One*, 12, e0173305.
- Buckland, S. T., Yuan, Y., & Marcon, E. (2017). Measuring temporal trends in biodiversity. *AStA Advances in Statistical Analysis*, 101, 461-474.
- Pavoine, S., Marcon, E., & Ricotta, C. (2016). 'Equivalent numbers' for species, phylogenetic or functional diversity in a nested hierarchy of multiple scales. *Methods in Ecology and Evolution*, 7(10), 1152-1163.
- Marcon, E., & Hérault, B. (2015). Decomposing phylodiversity. *Methods in Ecology and Evolution*, 6, 333-339.
- Marcon, E., & Hérault, B. (2015). *entropart*, an R package to measure and partition diversity. *Journal of Statistical Software*, 67, 1-26.
- Marcon, E., Scotti, I., Hérault, B., Rossi, V., & Lang, G. (2014). Generalization of the partitioning of Shannon diversity. *Plos One*, 9, e90289.
- Marcon, E., Hérault, B., Baraloto, C., & Lang, G. (2012). The decomposition of Shannon's entropy and a confidence interval for beta diversity. *Oikos*, 121, 516-522.



Present
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2003

Characterization of spatial patterns

I co-authored with Florence Puech a series of papers in the field of spatial microeconometrics. An R package is available.

- Marcon, E., & Puech, F. (2023). Mapping distributions in non-homogeneous space with distance-based methods. *Journal of Spatial Econometrics*, 4, 13.
- Lang, G., Marcon, E., & Puech, F. (2020). Distance-based measures of spatial concentration: Introducing a relative density function. *The Annals of Regional Science*, 64, 243-265.
- Marcon, E. (2019). Mesure de la biodiversité et de la structuration spatiale de l'activité économique par l'entropie. *Revue Économique*, 70(3), 305-326. English translation.
- Marcon, E., & Puech, F. (2017). A typology of distance-based measures of spatial concentration. *Regional Science and Urban Economics*, 62, 56-67.
- Marcon, E., Traissac, S., Puech, F., & Lang, G. (2015). Tools to characterize point patterns: *dbmss* for R. *Journal of Statistical Software*, 67, 1-15.
- Marcon, E., Traissac, S., & Lang, G. (2013). A statistical test for Ripley's function rejection of poisson null hypothesis. *ISRN Ecology*, Article ID 753475.
- Lang, G., & Marcon, E. (2013). Testing randomness of spatial point patterns with the Ripley statistic. *ESAIM: Probability and Statistics*, 17, 767-788.
- Marcon, E., Puech, F., & Traissac, S. (2012). Characterizing the relative spatial structure of point patterns. *International Journal of Ecology*, Article ID 619281.
- Marcon, E., & Puech, F. (2010). Measures of the geographic concentration of industries: Improving distance-based methods. *Journal of Economic Geography*, 10, 745-762.
- Marcon, E., & Puech, F. (2003). Evaluating the geographic concentration of industries using distance-based methods. *Journal of Economic Geography*, 3, 409-428.

2020
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2007

Tropical Forest Ecology

I contributed to several research programmes in French Guiana.

Kourou, Guyane française

- Schmitt, S. *et al.* (2020). Topography consistently drives intra- and inter-specific leaf trait variation within tree species complexes in a Neotropical forest. *Oikos*, 129, 1521-1530.
- Richard-Hansen *et al.* (2015). Landscape patterns influence communities of medium- to large-bodied vertebrate in undisturbed terra firme forests of French Guiana. *Journal of Tropical Ecology*, 31, 423-436.
- Coste, S. *et al.* (2010). Assessing foliar chlorophyll contents with the SPAD-502 chlorophyll meter: A calibration test with thirteen tree species of tropical rainforest in French Guiana. *Annals of Forest Science*, 67, 607.
- Baraloto, C., Marcon, E., Morneau, F., Pavoine, S., & Roggy, J.-C. (2010). Integrating functional diversity into tropical forest plantation designs to study ecosystem processes. *Annals of Forest Science*, 67, 303.
- Blanc, L. *et al.* (2009). Dynamics of aboveground carbon stocks in a selectively logged tropical forest. *Ecological Applications*, 19, 1397-1404.
- Bonal, D. *et al.* (2007). The successional status of tropical rainforest tree species is associated with differences in leaf carbon isotope discrimination and functional traits. *Annals of Forest Science*, 64, 169-176.

Present
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2019

Ecology

I contribute to syntheses and large-scale studies papers in ecology.

- Hordijk, I. *et al.* (2025). Effect of climate on traits of dominant and rare tree species in the world's forests. *Nature Communications*, 16, 4773.
- Mo, L. *et al.* (2024). The global distribution and drivers of wood density and their impact on forest carbon stocks. *Nature Ecology & Evolution*, 8, 2195-2212.
- Hordijk, I. *et al.* (2024). Dominance and rarity in tree communities across the globe: Patterns, predictors and threats. *Global Ecology and Biogeography* 33, e13889.
- Zou, Y. *et al.* (2024). Positive Feedbacks and Alternative Stable States in Forest Leaf Types. *Nature Communications* 15, 4658.
- Bouchard, E. *et al.* (2024). Global patterns and environmental drivers of forest functional composition. *Global Ecology and Biogeography*, 33, 303-324.
- Mo, L. *et al.* (2023). Integrated global assessment of the natural forest carbon potential. *Nature*, 624, 92-101.
- Ma, H. *et al.* (2023). The global biogeography of tree leaf form and habit. *Nature Plants*, 9, 1795-1809.
- Hordijk, I. *et al.* (2023). Evenness mediates the global relationship between forest productivity and richness. *Journal of Ecology*, 111, 1308-1326.
- Delavaux, C. S. *et al.* (2023). Native diversity buffers against severity of non-native tree invasions. *Nature*, 621, 773-781.
- Liang, J. *et al.* (2022). Co-limitation towards lower latitudes shapes global forest diversity gradients. *Nature Ecology & Evolution*, 6, 1423-1437.
- Kattge, J. *et al.* (2020). TRY plant trait database – enhanced coverage and open access. *Global Change Biology*, 26, 119-188.
- Steidinger, B. S. *et al.* (2019). Climatic controls of decomposition drive the global biogeography of forest tree symbioses. *Nature*, 569, 404-408.

Present | 2007

Student supervision

I contribute to the publications of students I supervise.

- Goulpeau, A., Hedde, M., Ganault, P., Lapied, E., Maggia, M.-E., Marcon, E., & Decaëns, T. (2025). Biotic interactions and environmental filtering both determine earthworm alpha and beta diversity in tropical rainforests. *Oecologia*, 207, 151
- Badouard, V., Verley, P., Bai, Y., Sellan, G., Françoise, L., Marcon, E., Derroire, G., & Vincent, G. (2025). Using high penetration airborne LiDAR and dense UAV scanning to produce accurate 3D maps of light availability in dense tropical forest. *Agricultural and Forest Meteorology*, 373, 110713
- Nemetschek, D., Fortunel, C., Marcon, E., Auer, J., Badouard, V., Baraloto, C., Boisseaux, M., Bonal, D., Coste, S., Dardevette, E., Heuret, P., Hietz, P., Levionnois, S., Maréchaux, I., Stahl, C., Vleminckx, J., Wanek, W., Ziegler, C., Derroire, G. (2024). Love Thy Neighbour? Tropical Tree Growth and Its Response to Climate Anomalies Is Mediated by Neighbourhood Hierarchy and Dissimilarity in Carbon and Water Related Traits. *Ecology Letters*, 28, e70028
- Goulpeau, A., Hedde, M., Ganault, P., Lapied, E., Maggia, M.-E., Marcon, E., Decaëns, T. (2025) Dissecting Earthworm Diversity in Tropical Rainforests. *Ecography*, 2025, e07697
- Kaçamak, B., Réjou-Méchain, M., Rowe, N., Rossi, V., Barbier, N., Bazan, S., Forni, E., Guibal, D., Harris, D.J., Loubota Panzou, G.J., Loumeto, J., Marcon, E., Pinho, B.X., Zombo, I., Gourlet-Fleury, S. (2025). Local Forest Structure and Host Specificity Influence Liana Community Composition in a Moist Central African Forest. *Ecology and Evolution*, 15, e71075
- Nemetschek, D., Derroire, G., Marcon, E., Aubry-Kientz, M., Auer, J., Badouard, V., Baraloto, C., Bauman, D., Le Blaye, Q., Boisseaux, M., Bonal, D., Coste, S., Dardevet, E., Heuret, P., Hietz, P., Levionnois, S., Maréchaux, I., McMahon, S. M., Stahl, C., Vleminckx, J., Wanek, W., Ziegler, C., & Fortunel, C. (2024). Climate anomalies and neighbourhood crowding interact in shaping tree growth in old-growth and selectively logged tropical forests. *Journal of Ecology*,112, 590-612
- Penel, B., Freycon, V., Marcon, E., Rossi, V., Cornu, G., Bénédet, F., Forni, E., & Gourlet-Fleury, S. (2022). Macrotermes termite mounds influence the spatial pattern of tree species in two African rainforest sites, in northern Congo. But were they really forests in the past? *Journal of Tropical Ecology*, 38, 267-274.
- Mirabel, A., Marcon, E., & Hérault, B. (2021). 30 Years of postdisturbance recruitment in a Neotropical forest. *Ecology and Evolution*, 11, 14448-14458.
- Mirabel, A., Hérault, B., & Marcon, E. (2020). Diverging taxonomic and functional trajectories following disturbance in a Neotropical forest. *Science of The Total Environment*, 720, 137397.
- Ollivier, M., Baraloto, C., & Marcon, E. (2007). A trait database for Guianan rain forest trees permits intra- and inter-specific contrasts. *Annals of Forest Science*, 64, 781-786.

Present | 2015

Books

I wrote two scientific books which are available in open access on HAL and are kept up to date on GitHub.

- Marcon, E. (2021). Working R. UMR Amap. Montpellier, France. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.5778902.
- Marcon, E. (2018). Mesures de la Biodiversité. UMR EcoFoG Kourou, France. https://agroparistech.hal.science/cel-01205813v5.

Working with R

Travailler avec R (in French)

Mesures de la Biodiversité (in French)

Present | 2003

Reviewing

I am a reviewer for many scientific journals.

- Acta Biotheoretica
- Acta Oecologica
- Agricultural and Forest Meteorology
- Annals of Forest Science
- AStA Advances in Statistical Analysis
- Biodiversity and Conservation
- Bois et Forêts des Tropiques
- Cybergeo
- Data in Brief
- Diversity
- Diversity and Distributions
- Ecography
- Ecological Indicators
- Ecological Informatics
- Ecology and Evolution
- Ecology Letters
- Économie et Prévision
- Économie et Statistique
- Empirical Economics
- Entropy
- Environmental and Ecological Statistics
- Environmetrics
- Forest Ecosystems
- Forestry Ideas
- Forests
- Geographical Analysis
- Hacettepe Journal of Mathematics and Statistics
- Indian Journal of Science & Technology
- Journal of Classification
- Journal of Economic Geography
- Journal of Environmental Management
- Journal of Geographical Systems
- Journal of the Royal Statistical Society
- Journal of Theoretical Biology
- Journal of Vegetation Science
- Land
- Mathematics
- Methods in Ecology and Evolution
- Microorganisms
- Nitrogen
- Molecular Ecology Resources
- Oecologia
- One Earth
- Papers in Regional Science
- PeerJ
- Planning Practice and Research
- Plants
- Plos ONE
- Quality & Quantity
- Regional Science and Urban Economics
- Regional Studies
- Science of the Total Environment
- Scientific Reports
- Spatial Economic Analysis
- Stochastic Environmental Research and Risk Assessment
- Sustainability
- The Innovation
- The R Journal
- Theoretical Ecology
- Theory in Biosciences
- Transactions in GIS
- Urban Geography
- Urban Studies
- Web Ecology

SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT

2015

entropart

entropart is an R package that provides functions to calculate alpha, beta and gamma diversity of communities, including phylogenetic and functional diversity. Estimation-bias corrections are available.

Package entropart

2026

divent

divent is a reboot of entropart, making it easier to use and more efficient. It includes new features, namely spatially-explicit diversity.

Package divent

2015

dbmss

dbmss is an R package for simple computation of spatial statistic functions of distance to characterize the spatial structures of mapped objects, including classical ones (Ripley's K and others) and more recent ones used by spatial economists (Duranton and Overman's K_d, Marcon and Puech's M). It relies on spatstat for some core calculation.

Package dbmss

2021

memoiR

Templates to publish well-formatted and reproducible documents both in HTML and PDF formats.

Package memoiR